



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Thursday, 3rd July, 2025

The House met at 9.49 a.m.

[THE SPEAKER IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Prime Minister of the Republic of India has been scheduled to address this august House today. May I invite the Hon Majority and Minority Leaders to join me to receive Her Excellency Prof Naana Jane Opoku-Agyemang, the Vice President of the Republic of Ghana and the Prime Minister of the Republic of India, His Excellency Shri Narendra Modi at the Central Lobby.

Hon Leaders, we may proceed now.

[The Speaker, the Majority and Minority Leaders proceeded to the Central Lobby to receive Her Excellency the Vice President and His Excellency the Prime Minister of the Republic of India and conducted them into the Chamber.]

10.10 a.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, permit me to recognise, in this Chamber, the presence of H. E. Prof Naana Jane Opoku-Agyemang— *[Hear! Hear!]*—The Vice President of the Republic of

Ghana. I also want to recognise, before I invite our Special Guest, the following people. We have the veteran Hon Member of Parliament, Cletus Avoka, now a member of the Council of State, representing the Chairman of the Council of State— *[Hear! Hear!]*—The word “Bham Bham”, he learnt it from India—*[Laughter]*.

Hon Members, we also have members of the Council of State and representatives of political parties. We have members of the Diplomatic Corps. We have the Ga Mantse; we have independent constitutional bodies, civil society organisations, and a large presence of the Indian community in Ghana. *[Hear! Hear!]* You know our brothers and sisters from India; the community is very vibrant and hospitable and we live together in peace and friendship.

Now, permit me to acknowledge with high commendation the presence of H. E. Shri Narendra Modi, the Prime Minister of the Republic of India, in this august House — *[Hear! Hear!]*— Even before independence, we took a lot of inspiration from India, right from the formation of student groups in London to the time of their independence on the 15th August 1947. His Excellency the Prime Minister is here to address the House, pursuant to Order 67(1)(k) of the Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana.

On behalf of Leadership and Hon Members, it is my privilege and singular honour to welcome His Excellency the

Prime Minister of the Republic of India to this august House.

Hon Members, with your indulgence, I have the greatest pleasure to invite His Excellency to address the House.

Your Excellency, you may deliver your address now. [*Hear! Hear!*]

ADDRESS BY THE PRIME MINISTER OF INDIA

Prime Minister of India (H. E. Shri Narendra Modi): The Rt Hon Speaker, Leadership of the House, Hon Members of Parliament, members of the Council of State, members of the Diplomatic Corps, representatives of political parties, independent constitutional bodies, civil society organisations, the Indian community in Ghana, *m'aakye*; good morning. I am deeply honoured to address this esteemed House today.

It is a privilege to be in Ghana, a land that radiates the spirit of democracy, dignity and resilience. As the representative of the world's largest democracy, I bring with me the goodwill and greetings of 1.4 billion Indians — [*Hear! Hear!*]— Ghana is known as the land of gold, not just for what lies under your soil, but as much for the warmth and strength in your heart. When we look at Ghana, we see a nation that shines with courage that rises above history and that meets every challenge with dignity and grace. Your commitment to democratic ideals and inclusive progress truly makes Ghana a beacon of inspiration for the entire African continent — [*Hear! Hear!*].

Friends, last evening was a deeply moving experience. Receiving your national award from my dear friend, President Mahama, is an honour. I will always cherish that. *इच सम्मान के लिए, बै 140 करोड भारतियों की तरफ से, गाना के लोगों का आभार वक्त करता है।*

On behalf of the 1.4 billion people of India, I thank the people of Ghana for this honour. I dedicate it to the enduring friendship and shared values that bind India and Ghana — [*Hear! Hear!*].

10.20 p.m.

Distinguished Members, earlier today, I had the honour of paying tribute to a visionary statesman and beloved son of Ghana, Dr Kwame Nkrumah. [*Hear! Hear!*]—He once said, the forces that unite us are intrinsic and greater than the super-imposed influences that keep us apart. His words continue to guide our shared journey. His vision was a democratic republic, built on strong institutions. True democracy promotes discussion and debate. It unites people. It supports dignity and promotes human rights. Democratic values may take time to grow, but it is our responsibility to preserve and nurture them.

Mr Speaker, India is the mother of democracy—[*Hear! Hear!*]—[*H. E. Modi spoke in an Indian language*]—For us, democracy is not merely a system, it is a part of our fundamental values from thousands of years ago. We have examples of centers like Vaishali and the Rigveda. One of the oldest scriptures of the world says, *āno bhadraṅ kṛtavo*

yantu viśvatah. It means, let good thoughts come to us from all directions.

This openness to ideas is the core of democracy. India has over 2,500 political parties. I repeat, 2,500 political parties. There are 20 different parties governing different states, 22 official languages and thousands of dialects. This is also the reason that people who came to India have always been welcomed with open hearts. The same spirit helps Indians integrate easily wherever they go. Even in Ghana, they have blended into society just like sugar in tea. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Distinguished Members, the histories of India and Ghana bear the scars of colonial rule, but our spirits have always remained free and fearless. We draw strength and inspiration from our rich heritage. We take pride in our social, cultural and linguistic diversity. We build nations rooted in freedom, unity and dignity. Our relationship knows no bounds and with your permission, may I say, our friendship is sweeter than your famous sugar love pineapple—[*Laughter*]*—*With President Mahama, we have decided to elevate our ties to a comprehensive partnership. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Friends, the world order created after the World War II is changing fast. The revolution in technology, the rise of the global south and shifting demographics are contributing to its pace and scale. The challenges, such as colonial rule that humanity has faced in the earlier centuries still persists in different forms. The world is also facing new and

complex crises such as climate change, pandemics, terrorism and cyber security. Institutions created in the last century are struggling to respond.

The changing circumstances demand credible and effective reforms in global governance. Progress cannot come without giving voice to the global south. We need more than slogans; we need action. That is why during the G20 Presidency of India, we worked with vision, one earth, one family and one future. We put emphasis on the rightful place of Africa at the global high table. We are proud that the African Union (AU) became a permanent member of the G20 during our Presidency.

Mr Speaker, for India, our philosophy is humanity first. We believe in *sarve bhavantu sukhinah, sarve santu niramaya, sarve bhadrani paschantu, ma kasche dukh bhag bhave*. It means, may all be happy, may all be free from illness, may all feel what is auspicious, may no one suffer in any way.

This philosophy, embodies the approach of India to the world. It guided our actions during the COVID-19 pandemic.

10.30 p.m.

Auspicious, may no one suffer in any way. This philosophy embodies India's approach to the world. It guided our actions during the COVID-19 pandemic. We shared vaccines and medicines with over 150 countries including our friends in Ghana. [*Hear! Hear!*]

We launched mission lifestyle for environment to address climate change and promote sustainable living. This inclusive spirit powers our global initiatives like “One Sun, One World, One Grid” and “One World, One Health, for Healthier Planet”. We introduced the International Solar Alliance to encourage solar energy and sustainability, International Big Cat Alliance to protect wildlife, and the Global Biofuel Alliance to advance clean biofuels and cut carbon emissions. I am glad that Ghana as a founding member will host the African regional meeting for the International Solar Alliance this September. This demonstrates our shared belief that the world is one family.

Distinguished Members, over the past decade, India has seen a major transformation. The people of India have reposed their faith in peace, security and development. Last year, they re-elected the same government for the third consecutive time. Something that happened after more than six decades. Today, India is the fastest growing emerging economy. On the foundations of stable polity and good governance, India will soon be the third largest economy. We already contribute nearly 16 per cent to global growth. Our demography is paying its dividend. India now has the world’s third largest start-up ecosystem. India is an innovation and technology hub where global companies want to converge. We are recognised as the pharmacy of the world. Indian women today lead in science, space, aviation and sports. India landed on the moon, and today an Indian is in orbit giving wings to our human space flight mission.

[H. E. Modi spoke in an Indian language]

Africa has been connected to many of India’s proudest moments in space. When India’s Chandrayaan landed on the moon’s south pole, I was in Africa. And today, as an Indian astronaut conducts experiments on board the Space Station for the welfare of humanity, I am once again in Africa. *[Hear! Hear!]*

This is no ordinary coincidence. It reflects the deep bond we share, our common aspirations and our shared future. Our development is inclusive. Our growth touches the lives of every Indian. The people of India have resolved to make India a developed nation by 2047 when we celebrate 100 years of independence.

As Ghana continues to pursue the path of progress and prosperity, India shall walk with you shoulder to shoulder on this road. India shall walk with you shoulder to shoulder on this road. *[Hear! Hear!]*

[H. E. Modi spoke in an Indian language]

In these times of global uncertainty, India’s democratic stability shines as a ray of hope. India’s rapid progress is a catalyst for global growth. As the world’s largest democracy, India is a pillar of strength for the world. A strong India will contribute to a more stable and prosperous world. *[Hear! Hear!]* After all, our mantra is, “*Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas, Sabka Prayas*”. It

means, together, for everyone's growth, with everyone's trust and effort, India remains a committed partner in Africa's development journey. We support Africa's Development Framework Agenda 2063 to secure a bright and sustainable future for its people. Africa's goals are our priorities; our approach is to grow together as equals. Our development partnership with Africa is demand-driven. It is focused on building local capacities and creating local opportunities. Our objective is not just to invest, but to empower, to help develop self-sustaining ecosystems.

It is my honour to give further momentum to this partnership. In 2015, we hosted the India-Africa Summit and President Mahama was one of our esteemed guests. In 2017, India hosted the annual meeting of the African Development Bank. We have expanded our diplomatic presence to 46 countries across Africa. Over 200 projects across the continent enhance connectivity, infrastructure and industrial capacity.

Every year, our India-Africa Business Conclave generates new opportunities. In Ghana, we inaugurated the Tema-Mpakadan railway line last year. It is the largest infrastructure project in this part of the African region.

10.40 a.m.

Address by the Prime Minister of India

Economic integration under the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA). Ghana also holds great

potential to become an Information Technology (IT) and innovation hub in the region. Together, we will shape a future full of promise and progress.

Distinguished Members, free and fair elections are the soul of any democracy. It is encouraging to see our Electoral Commissions working closely together. I am confident that India's Election Commission will be honoured to share its experience in conducting the world's largest elections with full trust and transparency.

Parliamentary exergies are also a cornerstone of the relationship between our two democracies. I recall the Commonwealth Parliamentary Association meeting held in Accra in 2023. It welcomed the largest Indian parliamentary delegation to Ghana, including state legislators in India. We deeply value such vibrant dialogue. I welcome the establishment of Ghana-India Parliamentary Friendship Society in your Parliament. *[Hear! Hear!]* I propose to further reinforce our parliamentary ties.

I invite you to visit the new Parliament of India. You will be able to see the bold steps we have taken to reserve one-third of seats in the Indian Parliament and state assemblies for women. You can witness the debate and discussions that are the hallmark of the Indian democracy. I assure you they are as spirited and passionate as the game of your beloved Black Stars. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Friends, India and Ghana share a dream; a dream where every child gets

opportunities, where every voice is heard, where nations rise together, not apart. Dr Nkrumah said, and I quote, “I am not African because I was born in Africa, but because Africa was born in me.” *[Hear! Hear!]*. In the same way, India carries Africa in its heart. *[Hear! Hear!]* Let us build a partnership, not only for today, but for generations to come.

Thank you. *Medamoase. [Hear! Hear!]*

The Speaker: Hon Members, you may resume your seats. You have heard it all; the wisdom of the Prime Minister of the largest democracy in the world. *[Hear! Hear!]* A population more than the population in Africa with 2,500 political parties and 22 official languages. No wonder they established the Public Accounts Committee that we know today as far back as 1921. So, in 2021 they celebrated 100 years of Public Accounts Committee in India. I want to assure His Excellency that our Public Accounts Committee will visit your Parliament to understudy your journey and to learn from you. *[Uproar]*

Hon Members, we definitely would have cherished the words of warmth and wisdom from our Leaders, but we are seriously constrained and we are compelled to go by that. So, I apologise that we do not have space even though initially, we provided for it because of the tightness of the schedule. So, I will, with all humility, crave your indulgence to on your behalf to please extend our warmest congratulations to His Excellency the Prime Minister of the

Republic of India. We are honoured by his presence. It was really a great pleasure listening to him.

So, Your Excellency, on behalf of the Parliament of Ghana, the 275 Members that is not a large number compared to yours, I convey the gratitude of the House to you and through you to the good brotherly people of India. We are extremely grateful, and with your kind permission, I will now proceed to suspend the Sitting.

Please, I definitely can only once again appreciate the efforts that Her Excellency the Vice President has put in by leading this august visitor to our House. *[Hear! Hear!]* On your behalf, I thank her for all her love, support, assistance and the leadership that she has granted us so far.

10.50 a.m.

We are extremely grateful, Your Excellency. I believe I now have your blessing to proceed to suspend proceedings.

[Hon Alexander Akwasi Acquah made a gesture]. [Laughter]

I recognise that the Hon Member is itching to visit India. *[Hear! Hear!]* I want to assure you that I will not hold my pen from approving your visit. *[Uproar]*

Hon Members, please, time is not on our side, but my attention has been drawn to the fact that he is not alone; that he has a partner and she is outdooing herself straight in front of us. *[Hear!]*

Hear!] So, I thank Hon Members for the love for the country of India, its people and its culture.

And now, with your kind permission, may I proceed to suspend Sitting.

Thank you so much.

10.51 a.m. — *Sitting suspended*

Sitting resumed.

11.47 a.m.— *Sitting resumed.*

The Speaker: Hon Members, welcome back from the suspension. We want to commence the Business for today after listening to the address of our Special Guest.

So, we will start from the item numbered 6 on the Order Paper, Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and *Official Report*.

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

The Speaker: We start with the correction of *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 2nd July, 2025.

Page 1...17?

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, on page 17, the Business Committee is said to have met on Thursday, 2nd July. I think definitely that should be an error.

In the month of July, this is the only Thursday we have, which is today and it

is 3rd July. So, I presume the day in question should be Wednesday, 2nd July instead.

The Speaker: Business Committee, when did you meet? Was it Wednesday?

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Annoh Dompreeh: Mr Speaker, the observation by our Colleague is right. We met on Wednesday; that is yesterday.

The Speaker: Table Office, kindly take note.

Page 18...20?

Yes, Hon Member?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with utmost respect, I made some observations, but, because I walked in late, you have gone beyond those pages. If I find favour before you, I would like us to go to the item numbered 9(b) (184) (ii) on page 11. I am not sure whether it is supposed to be “Saboba” or “Sabuba”. I see “Sabuba” here and I am not sure whether that is the right rendition.

The Speaker: Hon Member, are you referring to page 11?

Prof Nyarko: Yes, page 11, the item numbered 9(b) (184) (ii), “Sabuba – Chereponi”

The Speaker: Yes, the spelling of the name “Sabuba” should be “bo”, not “bu”.

Yes, Hon Member, thank you so much.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, also, on page 17, where the Hon Member for Afadjato made the correction, if you come to the item numbered 3(iv), I see “PAC” ascribed to Ms Akua Osei-Somuah. I do not know whether it is Principal Assistant Clerk or Public Accounts Committee. So, it could be specific for us to be sure whether—I think it is Principal Assistant Clerk; it could also be Public Accounts Committee.

Mr Speaker, thanks for your patience.

The Speaker: Table Office, kindly take note of the use of the abbreviation, PAC. Make it specific; if it is Principal Assistant Clerk, say so. When you say PAC, commonly in Parliament, we know it to be Public Accounts Committee. The lady is actually a Principal Assistant Clerk.

Page 20...23?

Yes, Hon Member?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, on page 23, the item numbered 3(xix), Mr Christian Sowu is the headmaster and the “Head Master” is supposed to be one word, not separated. So, if we could correct that to make it “Headmaster” as one word.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you are right.

Table Office, kindly take note.

Page 24...25?

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, with respect, page 25, the item numbered 3(ii), Pastor Gideon Nimoh is supposed to be the campus coordinator. The word “cordinator” is wrongly spelt. So, if the Clerks-at-the-Table could take note and correct it accordingly—

Again, Mr Speaker, with your leave, on the same page, the item numbered 3(v), I think, in the spelling of “Mr Achibald”, there is an “r” missing.

11.57 a.m.

The Speaker: Table, kindly take note of the spelling of coordinator and crosscheck the spelling of “Achibald” because, usually, it is spelt differently, depending on who your teacher was. *[Laughter]*

Page 26...28—

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, at page 28, the item numbered 3(ii), under “In Attendance”, the Hon Member for Weija-Gbawe, Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib, his title here has been too elevated. It is written here as “Hon Member and Second Deputy Speaker”, but he is the Second Deputy Minority Whip, so the record should capture him as such.

The Speaker: Yes, you are right and I am sure he would not contest that.

Yes, Hon Member?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, furtherance to that observation, your very good name has been captured as “Rt Hon Kingsford Alban Sumana Bagbin”. I am not sure whether the narration has been captured correctly, but I think since we refer to you as “ASK Bagbin” or “ASK Baba”, it should read, “Rt Hon Alban Sumana Kingsford Bagbin”. The arrangement has been changed and we cannot do that to our respected, distinguished, very fantastic and knowledgeable Speaker of the Ghanaian Parliament who has done back-to-back on this most enviable seat. We cannot do that to you.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, that is why you are a professor. *[Laughter]*

Yes, my name is “ASK Bagbin”. People have been murdering it all over the place, but we just have to accept that it is “Alban Sumana Kingsford Bagbin (ASK)”. If you do not know, “ASK Bagbin”. That is how I got it in this House.

Yes, Hon Member?

Ms Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah: Mr Speaker, please, I want to beg your leave to take us back to page 24, on the tour of the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare to the orphanages with the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection. When we went to the orphanage in the constituency of Mrs Gizella Akushika Tetteh-Agbotui, she joined us in our meetings and activities and I thought that that should be captured in the Report. Mrs Faustina Elikplim Akurugu also

joined us when we visited another shelter in her constituency, Dome-Kwabanya.

Mr Speaker, I want to crave your indulgence and request that these two Hon Members of Parliament be duly recognised in the attendance of the activities of the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare.

The Speaker: Table, kindly take note of that

Page 29—

Sorry, Prof Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, still at page 28, it was the vetting of Justice Hafisata Amaleboba, but, curiously, under the item numbered 3, “In Attendance”, I do not see any of her relations. It is surprising that on an occasion of this nature, she came alone. Apart from you being there, which I suspect she might be your friend, none of her relations is captured. I do not know whether it was an omission or she came alone. So, if the Clerks-at-the-Table could check and if she came with some relations and friends, then that should be properly captured.

The Speaker: Actually, you reminded me; I was not in attendance. I was not present at the hearings of the Appointments Committee at all. So, how my name found its place there is a surprise to me. I do not know any of you who saw me there—My spirit was there?

— Was I there in spirit? How did you see my spirit? *[Laughter]*

Yes, Hon Member?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, still at page 28, I do not know if this has been corrected because I was not around. The item numbered 3(i), under “In Attendance”, Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib—

The Speaker: It has been corrected.

Mr Habib Iddrisu: All right. Thank you.

Ms Rita Naa Odoley Sowah: Mr Speaker, at page 21, under Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare, I am a Member and I was part of the team that went to the Motherly Love Orphanage located at Kwabenya, but my name has been omitted. That is Rita Naa Odoley Sowah.

The Speaker: Definitely, I know you very well. Please, Table, kindly take note of that.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the *Votes and Proceedings* captures two meetings of the Committee. So, if my Sister looks at page 18, her name is captured among those who attended in respect of the three orphanages they attended, namely, Save Them Young Orphanage, Great Mission International Orphanage and New Life Nungua Orphanage. Then, in respect of the Thursday, 22nd May, 2025, it was Osu

Royal Seed Home and Motherly Love Orphanage.

For the records, Table should reconcile the records properly, so that it will reflect which of the orphanages the Members attended.

The Speaker: Hon Member, did you listen to the Majority Chief Whip?

Ms Sowah: Mr Speaker, I was part of the team that went to the Motherly Love Orphanage located at Kwabenya.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, so that should be corrected.

Page 22...34—

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, at page 33, under “In Attendance”, it seems our Hon Brother, Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib, has seen an elevation.

12.07 p.m.

So, you have him here captured as “Second Deputy Minority Chief Whip”. It should be “Second Deputy Minority Whip”. Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you are right. It should be noted. We have Chief Whips and Deputy Whips. We do not have Deputy Chief Whips.

Page 34...36.

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 2nd July, 2025 is adopted as a true record of proceedings.

I have with me a copy of the *Official Report* of Tuesday, 24th June, 2025. Any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Tuesday, 24th June, 2025]

Now, item numbered 8 on the Order Paper. But before we do that, let me officially inform you that we are having a test transmission live on our own channel *[Hear! Hear!]*—Called Ghana Parliament TV. This channel is on the national terrestrial platform. It is part of our efforts to kick-start our own station, Parliament Broadcasting. We are also live on all our own social media platforms. We urge all to follow and participate in this morning's programme. Our collaboration is with our own Public Affairs Department. In fact, it is now a subdivision and the ICT Department.

So please, on your behalf, I want to congratulate our staff and Leadership because we must sustain our position as the most open and transparent Parliament in the continent *[Hear! Hear!]*—

I also want to inform you that we have some visitors here. As of now, I have two groups, usually our own sons and daughters, our beloved treasure. We have from Newtown DA Basic A

School, Dodowa. They are 60 in number, and they are led by their teacher by the name of Caesar Alfred-Baffour. Please, you can see them to the left and they come from Shai Osudoku. Please, you are warmly welcome and we encourage you to keep coming. You would learn more than we did and we pray that in future you perform better than we are doing. So, you are kindly welcome. You may resume your seats.

[Pupils from Newtown DA Basic A School, Dodowa were acknowledged]

We also have students from Offinso North. They are also 60 in number and they are led by their headteacher by the name Francis Awuah. They come from the constituency known as Offinso North. You are warmly welcome. I know Offinso North very well. I have a family there, so I visit there from time to time. They are warm people. Thank you for coming and keep on coming in spite of the distance and the cost. That is good investment and I assure you in future you will be better than those of us gathered here. You are most welcome. Resume your seats.

[Pupils from Offinso North were acknowledged]

Hon Members, we now take the item numbered 8 unless there is—

Yes, Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think there is some dialogue, and we propose to suspend the Questions slated under item numbered 8 and defer to next

week. So, if you grant us that leave, we will defer the Questions to next week, and rather with your kind leave, take item numbered 10 and the Order Paper *Addendum* so that we can lay the Papers and Reports, and then we will consider a very short programme for today. We will then take the Business Statement.

The Speaker: Hon Members, following the request of the Leader of the House, the Questions on page 2 and 3 of the Order Paper numbered 76, 110, 163, 173, 174, 193 and 239, are hereby deferred. They will be rescheduled, and the Ministers will be informed accordingly.

We now move on to item numbered 10, presentation of Papers—You want to do the Business Statement first? Please, item 10—Presentation of Papers. The following papers to be presented. Yes, 10(a)(i) to (v). Are they all ready? If they are, we will allow a bow to lay them all.

PAPERS

By the Majority Leader —

- (i) Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Procurement and Management of Medical Equipment in Teaching Hospitals.
- (ii) Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana, (Whole-of-Government Accounts) for the Year ended 31st December, 2024.
- (iii) Report of the Auditor-General on the Consolidated Statements of Foreign Exchange Receipts and

Payments of the Bank of Ghana (BoG) for the Year ended 31st December, 2024.

- (iv) Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana, Pre-University Educational Institutions for the Financial Year Ended 31st December 2024.

12.17 p.m.

- (v) Follow-up Report of the Auditor General on the Three Performance Audits in respect of: Regulating Small-Scale Mining for A Sustainable Environment; Sustainability of Sports Stadia in Ghana; and Administration of Scholarships by the GETFund.

Referred to the Public Accounts Committee.

The Speaker: Chairman of the Public Accounts Committee, you know our Standing Orders have permitted you to establish subcommittees of the Public Accounts Committee and then specialise in the various Reports.

There are so many now coming to the House, and we need to have that so you can expedite work on them. But the final Report will be brought definitely after the Chair and the Secretary have gone through and appended their signature to it.

So please, make sure the subcommittees are established so that you catch up. Thank you so much.

Yes, before the Majority Leader, the Chairman of the Education Committee.

Mr Peter Kwasi Nortsu-Kotoe: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, it is about the referrals that you have just made to the Public Accounts Committee. I have a suggestion to make. As we have been doing many a time, when you refer some reports to committees, you ask that the Leadership of some Committees join them. My observation with the Public Accounts Committee is that when they go through this, at times, we have other reports, and then when we go through, we realise that it becomes a duplication.

So if they are going to take anything on education, for instance, this one on the pre-tertiary institutions, the Leadership of the Committee on Education could be invited so that we can sit in and probably know what we can do when we are preparing our annual reports on these institutions. It is a suggestion I want to put across.

[Pause]

The Speaker: Chairperson, Public Accounts Committee, what do you say to this request?

Mrs Abena Osei-Asare: Mr Speaker, two days ago, this same issue came up and then we drew the attention to the fact

that Standing Order 229(5), just like you mentioned, allows us to set up some subcommittees, including educational institutions, management and utilisation of statutory funds, subcommittee on public accounts, subcommittee on performance audits and foreign exchange receipts and payments, subcommittee on monitoring and implementation, and then a subcommittee that we may determine.

The Constitution is also very clear on who should take such reports. They can come in as friends, and then we allow them to ask any questions that they have. But based on what the Constitution and our Standing Orders say, I think this Report should be referred to us, just like you have done, and we would have to look at it. You advised us to set up the committees, which we will do very soon, and let you know. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Leader, let me listen to your troops first.

Dr Eric Afful: Mr Speaker, in the same way, the Bank of Ghana (BoG) comes directly under your Committee, the Committee on Economy and Development. So, at least the Leadership can be added to the Public Accounts Committee to look into this Report. Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, Prof.?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with utmost respect, on Tuesday, this

matter came up. It was debated strongly, and there was a ruling that such reports must be referred to the Public Accounts Committee.

Mr Speaker, the issue our respected Majority Leader raised was that because it is a performance audit, one can never examine the performance audit report without looking at the financial aspect; it is part of it. So I do not see why we should get the Leadership of other committees to be part of the consideration of the Audit Report. It is clear it has to go to the Public Accounts Committee. There is no grey area on this matter.

Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, not to rehash what our respected Chair of the Public Accounts Committee said, this matter is a straightforward one. I can appreciate when Colleagues appreciate some angle of matters at hand, often referred to the Public Accounts Committee and believe they should have a bite. But with the greatest respect to our Colleagues, these are straightforward matters.

In my view, what is outstanding and if we look at the Constitution, is Parliament's inability to do a follow-up in terms of the issues that are teased out by the Public Accounts Committee. It often happens that we debate the issues and leave them hanging. This House's

ability to continue through to its logical conclusion —There is a Constitutional imperative that we should be able to form committees to get these matters addressed ultimately. That, for me, is the crux of the matter, and that is what we should be focusing on, not the referral.

With respect to my ever-passionate Chair and my Colleagues, let us leave this matter as it is. I think we have not erred at all. Do not fix it if it is not broken.

The Speaker: Yes?

Mr Isaac Adongo: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the issue of reports that are supposed to be referred to the Public Accounts Committee are not in doubt, but performance audit reports are internal management tools that the entities themselves conduct on their own. So, one would expect that to go to the sector committees that have oversight responsibilities to these agencies to look at them. But if it is an external audit by the Auditor-General, then it should appropriately go to the Public Accounts Committee. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, two days ago, what came up in this Chamber related to performance audit reports and I suggested that when it comes to performance reports, and not the audit of the accounts of the organisation, but an audit of the performance of the organisation, it will be very appropriate

for us to jointly refer it to the Public Accounts Committee and the sector Committee so that together, they can have a sense of how the agency or the organisation has performed.

12.27 p.m.

Because the sector Committee oversees the budgetary appropriations, it would be interested in the performance of that sector. But if it relates to the accounts of the organisation and how the moneys were spent or whether the processes were duly followed, then that will go to the Public Accounts Committee. We debated it exhaustively and the First Deputy Speaker took a view that every audit of the Auditor-General should go to the Public Accounts Committee alone. That was what came up three days ago. So, the sector Committee members are of the view that they want to participate in performance reports, and see how their agencies are performing.

Mr Speaker, I think that this House must strengthen the monitoring and evaluation responsibilities that we have. Committees may not be able to go out there and actually do an effective evaluation of the performance of agencies under them, but when a specialised body like the Auditor-General has done that performance evaluation and presented a report to us, I do not think that we should be territorial and say that because it is work that is coming from the Auditor-General, it must necessarily go to the Public Accounts Committee. If it is work that comes from Auditor-General, but has to

do with performance of an agency or an organisation and not necessarily the accounts of the agency or organisation—Even though I know that there is no way that, in looking at performance, they will not also look at their accounts—That is why we are not saying that it should be referred to just the sector Committee. We are saying that they should do a joint referral when it is a performance report, so that together, they can look at it and the sector Committees would be better informed. When next year's appropriation comes, and the allocations to the same agencies are before them and they are evaluating the performance of the agency before approving or recommending the allocations for approval, it will just make things better.

I do not see why we should be so territorial and say that even though it is about a report about the performance of educational institutions and not the accounts of the education institutions, as the Public Accounts Committee, we should be allowed to set our own sub-committee on education when this House already has a Committee on Education.

Mr Speaker, I plead that we should rethink that. The First Deputy Speaker ruled on it three days ago; we are not challenging his ruling, but Mr Speaker, you may want to take time, think about it and then give us some direction now or at a future date.

The Speaker: Hon Members, our Rules are clear. I think the decision of the First Deputy Speaker is right and we should go by it. The subject matter

Committees should be able to use the Public Accounts Committee Reports in monitoring and evaluating the performance of their subject Ministries. That is allowed, but when we come to the issue of the Public Accounts Committee, it is a specialised Committee with a different composition. It is not only made up of Members, we also have experts from the Auditor-General. The Auditor-General in good democratic jurisdictions is an officer of Parliament who is usually an appointee of Parliament, not of the Executive. This constitutional reform should take that on board. It is very difficult for the Auditor-General, as an appointee of the Executive, to audit his own boss. So usually, the practice is for the Auditor-General to be an appointee of Parliament. So, they support them to do technical jobs and the other sector Committees can rely on these technical jobs in overseeing the performance of the sectors. So let us go by the initial ruling of the First Deputy Speaker.

But as we know, our Rules do not permit us to revisit a decision taken during the Meeting for discussion. So, Members, please save us the trouble of having to bring the Speaker to try to review decisions of his Deputy. That is definitely not a good practice too.

So let us take it as decided and then we will move on from that. If during the course of it we have challenges, we can definitely always look at our Standing Orders again.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we have Order Paper *Addendum* and there is a presentation and First Reading of a Bill, Ghana Deposit Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2025. If we may take that.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, Order Paper *Addendum*. My attention has been drawn to that Bill and so—

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is out of the jurisdiction. We have the Minister for Roads and Highways, if you will indulge us so that he can lay the Bill on behalf of the Minister for Finance.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is not here. Has the Deputy Minister for Finance elected not to be here? Where is he? On such an important matter? The Minister for Roads and Highways is our Friend; he often comes here. But do not use the Minister for Roads and Highways as a smokescreen.

The Minister for Roads and Highways is overburdened. Already, he has too many problems at his Ministry; he has to pay contractors. He is suffering. Every day, the Majority Side wants the Minister for Roads and Highways to lay Papers. They should find another Minister. They should at least bring Mr Nyarko Ampem. They should be minded that there are payments to be made. And tomorrow is a holiday. There are payments that the Minister for Finance has to honour, but he has still has not honoured them. Mr Speaker, we strongly argue that they should at least get —

[*Interruption*] No, I know the Minister will do my road for me. He should not forget that I am his good Friend. They should bring the Deputy Minister for Finance.

The Speaker: Please, do not intimidate the Minority Chief Whip. Allow him to do his job. You are giving him those signals that if he continues, his road might not be done. It is not fair. I assure you; your road will be done. Please, this is the work of the Minority, and they are drawing your attention to the fact that you must always get your Ministers to come and do their job before the House. So kindly concede and improve upon it so that we can proceed.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, that is so. Indeed, I pleaded with them this morning. That is why they agreed that we should even do the Order Paper *Addendum* and then lay this Bill this morning. We negotiated to make it a very short Sitting today, so that we can start our journey for a long weekend.

So, I am pleading with them. Mr Speaker says after I have pleaded, he will now allow the Minister for Roads and Highways to lay the Bill on behalf of the Minister for Finance. I have heard my Friend, the Minority Leader, whispering to his Frontbench that they should insist on the Deputy Minister for Finance being in the Chamber. Why is my Brother doing that? What is the problem? He and I had breakfast and we enjoyed ourselves this morning.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please.

Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I know the Majority Chief Whip has been whispering to him. So he is under the impression that I have also been applying the same formula. Our formulas are different; our approach and formula are different. So, I am aware the engagement the Majority Leader had with Alhaji Habib was to the effect that we defer the Question on Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs.

12.37 p.m.

Mr Speaker, for the love of our country—And I know how desperate he is. If we do not do this one, he will not have money to pay contractors. That is how desperate he is. They should be applauding the Minority. We warned them and they did not listen.

Anyway, for the love of our country, Mr Speaker, I will allow the Minister for Roads and Highways, but he should not forget there are things he has to do. Minister for Roads and Highways, there are roads in my constituency.

Mr Speaker, on that score, we will permit him to lay the Paper.

The Speaker: I am happy that, sometimes, you can be friends. We do not see that often and, please, let us see that you work together and you build consensus.

Please, Minister for Roads and Highways, you may do so now.

BILL — FIRST READING
Ghana Deposit Protection
(Amendment) Bill, 2025

AN ACT to amend the Ghana Deposit Protection Act, 2016 (Act 931) to enable the Ghana Deposit Protection Corporation to better achieve the object of protecting a depositor from loss as a result of the occurrence of an incurred event in respect of a member of the scheme to support the development of a safe, sound, efficient, and stable market-based financial system to ensure that the Ghana Deposit Protection Scheme conforms to international best practice and to provide for related matters.

Presented by Minister for Roads and Highways on behalf of the Minister for Finance. Read the First time; referred to the Committee on Finance.

The Speaker: I encourage the Leadership of the Committee on Economy and Development to participate in the deliberation of this matter.

Please, anymore? If not, I will hand over to the First Deputy Speaker. I have some delegation waiting on me.

First Deputy Speaker, take the Chair.

Mr Ayariga: All right. We will take the Business Statement.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 7, the Business Statement for the Seventh Week.

Chairman of the Business Committee?

12.41p.m.— [THE FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER IN THE CHAIR]

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Chairman of the Business Committee/Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, your Committee met yesterday, Wednesday, 2nd July, 2025, and arranged Business of the House for the Seventh Week, ending Saturday, 12th July, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its Report as follows:

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Question(s)

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers and the Governor of the Bank of Ghana to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

No. of Question(s)

i.	Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry	7
ii.	Minister for the Interior	7
iii.	Minister for Transport	5
iv.	Minister for Roads and Highways	7
v.	Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources	5
vi.	Governor of the Bank of Ghana	1
vii.	Minister for Food and Agriculture	6
	Attorney-General and Minister for Justice	3
viii.	Minister for Defence	2
ix.	Minister for Health	5
x.	Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs	7

Total Number of Questions**55**

Mr Speaker, in all, 10 Ministers and the Governor of the Bank of Ghana are expected to attend upon the House to respond to 55 Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

- i. Urgent – **12**; ii. Oral – **43**

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to

make Statements on Government policy. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159, Bills may be presented to the

House for First Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160.

Pursuant to Order 97, Papers may be laid during the Week and Reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential

Resolutions, if any, taken during the Week.

Sitting of the House on Mondays and Saturdays

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee brings to the notice of Hon Members that, in the coming weeks, the House will sit on Mondays and Saturdays commencing Monday, 7th July, 2025. This will allow for the maturity of some Legislative Instruments before the House adjourns *sine die*.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee also is announcing to the House that we have begun test transmission of proceedings of this House live on national television on a channel that is known as Ghana Parliament TV. It is the first stage. Subsequently, the Business Committee is making arrangements to also ensure that the sittings of Committees are also broadcast live on the same channel and, ultimately, sittings of Committees outside Parliament House, be they site visits or retreats or meetings in other conference facilities outside this House, will also be transmitted live. So, it is live on a GTV

channel. It is a GTV channel, so it is transmitted all over the country.

I believe that this will be an additional motivation for Members to participate in proceedings in the House, so that our constituents will see us live in action in the Chamber and at Committee sittings. The test transmissions began today, so I believe, as we speak, we are carried live on GTV across the country.

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216(2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the Week.

Monday, 7th July, 2025

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

Motions

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Presbyterian College of Education, Akropong-Akuapem for the year 2024
- (b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Communication Technology University for the year 2024

- (c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nusrat Jahan Ahmadiyya College of Education for the year 2024
- (d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mount Mary College of Education, Somanya, for the year 2024
- (e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) for the year 2024

Tuesday, 8th July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Urgent Questions

(a) **Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin (Effutu):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry what progress has been made in the development of a comprehensive National Agro-Industry Policy and how the Ministry intends to ensure that this policy translates into value addition, improved market access and export-led growth for Ghana's agricultural sector.

(b) **Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku (Offinso South):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry what steps the Ministry is taking to curb the resurgence of inferior cement into the market.

Questions

***20. Mr Davis Ansah Opoku (Mpraeso):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the steps being taken by the Ministry to operationalise the rural enterprise factory in Mpraeso.

***21. Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama (Walewale):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the plans of the Ministry to ensure the operation of the Walewale Watermelon Factory that was recently commissioned under the One District One Factory (1D1F) Policy.

***181. Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin (Effutu):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the specific incentives and investment promotion packages being deployed to attract private sector investment, given the cancellation of the One District One Factory (1D1F) Policy.

***235. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Industry and Agribusiness what policy measures the Ministry is implementing to support the growth and competitiveness of the private sector.

***240. Ms Fatahiya Abdul-Aziz (Savelugu):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the steps the Ministry has taken towards the implementation of the Women in Trade, Agribusiness and Industry Programme, particularly concerning the development of the Policy intended to support and empower women engaged in cross-border trade.

Presentation of Papers

(#)**Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the year 2024.**

Motions

Presentation of papers

Committee Sittings

Wednesday, 9th July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Urgent Questions

(a) Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South): To ask the Minister for the Interior what steps the Ministry is taking to re-classify Narcotics Control Commission as a Security and Intelligence Agency given their crucial and sensitive mandate as a drug enforcement agency.

(b) Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South): To ask the Minister for the Interior what steps the Ministry is taking to procure and install narcotics detection scanners at all critical and required checkpoint at the Airports and Cargo Sections to replace the broken-down scanners to ensure effective narcotics control.

(c) Mr Eric Owusu Agyemang-Prempeh (Ahafo Ano North): To ask the Minister for the Interior the measures

the Ministry is implementing to investigate the interception of over GH¢1million in cash hidden in 68 fertiliser bags aboard a commercial vehicle at Juapong which occurred on 3rd June, 2025.

(d) Mr Emmanuel Kwaku Boam (Pru East): To ask the Minister for Transport whether the Ministry has considered the feasibility and potential economic gains of constructing a permanent bridge across the Volta Lake between Yeji and Makango, in order to provide a safer, more reliable and efficient transportation link between these two towns.

Questions

***148. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for the Interior why the government chose to deport arrested foreign nationals who engaged in illegal mining instead of prosecuting them.

***169. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for the Interior the state of the interception of an alleged massive haul of counterfeit US dollars, Ghanaian cedi notes and suspected gold bars hidden in 20-foot containers at a warehouse in Sapeiman on 9th March, 2025.

***171. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for the Interior to provide an update on arrests made on 4th March, 2025 on the Cape Coast to Takoradi Highway in respect of some substances alleged to be illicit drugs.

***172. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for the Interior the current status of the implementation of the National Security Strategy outlined by H.E. Nana Addo Dankwa Akuffo-Addo in the year 2020.

***187. Mr Mumuni Muhammed Nurideen (Nalerigu/Gambaga):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of Nalerigu-Sakogu-Nakpanduri-Bunkpurugu roads awarded by the previous government would be completed.

***204. Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe (Prestea Huni-Valley):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of the Bogoso Nsu-Siding Huni Valley road.

***205. Mr Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah (Ahafo Ano South West):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the update on re-awarding the bitumen surfacing of Mpasaaso Number 2 to the Asuorkor feeder road, as there was a recommendation to terminate the contract in 2023.

***208. Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe (Prestea Huni-Valley):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the measures being implemented to improve the Prestea and Huni-Valley township roads.

***206. Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (Yilo Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the following roads in Yilo Krobo will be fixed: (i) Sikabeng to Agogo (ii) Huhunya to Boti

(iii) Nsutapong to Opesika (iv) Bosomtwi to Akpamu.

***207. Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (Yilo Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when work on the Somanya to Kpong road will resume and be completed.

***209. Mr Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah (Ahafo Ano South West):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the progress on the upgrade to bitumen surfacing of the Wiawso to Wansamere feeder road stretch (Km: 12.00- 40.37) which was awarded to contractors in 2018.

***89. Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (Ofoase/Ayirebi):** To ask the Minister for Transport the timelines for promoting the installation of solar systems in public building to be used for charging vehicles in accordance with Section 5.1.4(2) of the Electronic Vehicle Policy of Ghana.

***90. Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (Ofoase/Ayirebi):** To ask the Minister for Transport the timelines for reviewing existent relevant laws to accommodate the electric vehicle ecosystem in Ghana and which laws it will be affected by.

***91. Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (Ofoase/Ayirebi):** To ask the Minister for Transport the timelines for the programme of the Government to provide monetary and non-monetary incentives to facilitate the penetration of electronic vehicles into Ghana in accordance with section 5.1.1 of the Electronic Vehicle Policy of Ghana.

***114 Mr Seth Osei-Akoto (Atwima Mponua):** To ask the Minister for Transport when the construction of the paved rock lorry park with water closet toilet, shed and mechanised borehole at the Nyinahin Market would be completed.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Volta River Authority for the year 2024.
- (b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bui Power Authority for the year 2024.
- (c) Annual Report on Public Private Partnership Projects for the Year 2024.
- (d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Land Use and Spatial Planning Authority (LUPSA) for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee Sittings

Thursday, 10th July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Urgent Questions

(a) **Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs the immediate steps the Ministry is

implementing to address the outcry and distress of citizens caused by the prolonged shortage of papers used for printing of biometric birth certificates as well as the recurrence of this specific challenge faced by the Births and Deaths Registry.

(b) **Mr Emmanuel Kwaku Boam (Pru East):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources what plans the Ministry is implementing to ensure that Parambo-Sawaba Community is provided with safe and sustainable water in the shortest possible time.

(c) **Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri):** To ask the Governor of the Bank of Ghana the state of affairs regarding the close to hundred (100) employees who endured distress following the termination of their employment.

Questions

***76. Mr Alhassan Umar (Zabzugu):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs the total cost of the nationwide street naming and digitalisation conducted.

***110. Mr Seth Osei-Akoto (Atwima Mponua):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs when work will resume on the construction of the Youth Resource Centre at Nyinahin, the district capital.

***163. Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib (Weija-Gbawe):** To ask the Minister for

Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs to provide a detailed report on the circumstances surrounding the deaths of seven Ghanaian pilgrims during the 2025 Hajj, including the specific causes, measures implemented to ensure pilgrim safety and prevent future occurrences.

***173. Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie (Odododiodioo):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs for a comprehensive update on the status of the stalled Salaga market redevelopment project.

***174. Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie (Odododiodioo):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs the specific measures the Ministry is implementing to enhance fire safety infrastructure in major markets such as Rawlings Park, Timber Market, Makola market and Kantamanto market.

***193. Mr Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah (Ahafo Ano South West):** To ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs the actions the Ministry has implemented to rectify and facilitate the immediate formal commissioning of the Mankranso Methodist ICG Block, which was completed after twelve (12) years of being abandoned.

***182. Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie (Odododiodioo):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources what concrete steps the Ministry is taking to ensure consistent access to potable water for households in

Odododiodioo, particularly in old Fadama, where water shortages have persisted for over six years.

12:47 p.m

***183. Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie (Odododiodioo):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the steps the Ministry is taking to upgrade drainage systems in Odododiodioo to mitigate perennial flooding, particularly in low-lying areas such as Agbogbloshie township.

***198. Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (Yilo Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources when work will resume and be completed on the water extension project from Huhunya to Boti to Agogo to Opesika to Nsutapong to Akpo to Akpamu in the Yilo Krobo Municipality, which has halted since January 2025.

***199. Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (Yilo Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources, the plans of the Ministry for the rebuilding of the Klo-Agogo and the Nkrakan Markets in Yilo Krobo.

***149. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture why Ghana has maintained the current cocoa price despite the recent announcement of a cocoa price increase in Côte d'Ivoire.

***229. Mr Ernest Kumai (Akwatia):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the measures being taken to enhance farmers' access to certified

seeds and high-quality planting materials.

***230. Mr Seth Osei-Akoto (Atwima Mponua):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the policies being instituted to attract private sector investment into the crop production value chains.

***231. Mr Francis Kwabena Owusu Akyaw (Juaben):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what policy measures the Ministry is implementing to enhance crop production throughout the country.

***232. Mr Isaac Yaw Opoku (Offinso-South):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the alternative measures the Ministry is deploying to assist farmers with seedling production, given the challenges associated with relying on topsoil for raising seedlings and its impact on productivity. ***233.**

Mr Ralph Poku-Adusei (Bekwai): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the steps being taken to promote climate-resilient crop varieties and strengthen adaptive practices among farmers affected by erratic rainfall patterns.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ketu North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

- (b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Anloga District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asunafo South District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the North Tongu District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Denkyembour District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (f) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of Greater Accra Coordinating Council for the year 2024.
- (g) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Adaklu District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (h) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Petroleum Authority for the year 2024.
- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Suhum Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (j) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asante Akim Central Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (k) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Adentan Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

- (l) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the La Dade-Kotopon Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (m) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of Upper West Akim District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (n) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ada East District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (o) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Shai-Osudoku District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (p) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Effutu Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (q) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ada West District Assembly for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee Sitzings

Friday, 11th July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Urgent Questions

(a) Osahen Alexander Afenyo-Markin (Effutu): To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the rationale behind holding a press conference to justify the filing of a Nolle Prosequi, given that it falls within the mandate of the Ministry and does not require external justification, and to clarify whether such public explanations align with best practices.

(b) Osahen Alexander Afenyo-Markin (Effutu): To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the legal basis for his authorisation of the arrest of Professor Ameyaw-Akumfi by the National Intelligence Bureau (NIB) on Sunday, 23rd February, 2025, given that Article 88 (3) of the 1992 Constitution provides a clear mandate of the exercise of his ministerial powers.

(c) Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South): To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, what steps the Ministry is taking to ensure expeditious prosecution of criminal narcotic cases.

Questions

***166. Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To ask the Minister for Defence whether the presidential jet was unavailable, restricted or assigned other duties at the time the Vice President returned to Ghana aboard a private jet.

***167. Mr Mumuni Muhammed Nurideen (Nalerigu/Gambaga):** To ask the Minister for Defence when the Forward Operation Base (FOB) started by the previous government in Nalerigu will be completed.

***85. Dr Kingsley Agyemang (Abuakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Health the novel perspective of the Ministry on preventive medicine giving the high and rising burden of non-communicable diseases.

***127. Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To ask the Minister for Health to provide a detailed report on the current state of the construction of the maternity ward at the Tafo Government Hospital, when it is expected to be completed and to indicate if Government has plans to ensure its prompt completion.

***195. Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib (Weija-Gbawe):** To ask the Minister for Health the measures being implemented to address the concerns of thirty thousand (30,000) trained but unemployed health workers who are demanding posting despite critical staff shortages in health facilities across the nation.

***194. Mr Peter Lanchene Toobu (Wa West):** To ask the Minister for Health when the construction of the following three (3) health centres in the Wa West District, which have been abandoned since 2017, will be completed: (i) Gurungu (ii) Vieri (iii) Eggu.

***156. Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie (Odododiodioo):** To ask the Minister for Health the measures instituted to address the long-standing shortage of resident paediatricians or doctors at Princess Marie Louise Children's Hospital in Accra.

Presentation of Papers

(#) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Ghana Medical Centre for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee Sittings

Saturday, 12th July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Koforidua Technical University for the year 2024.
- (b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the OLA College of Education, Cape Coast, for the year 2024.
- (c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Accra Technical University for the year 2024.
- (d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kumasi Technical University for the year 2024
- (e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ada College of Education for the year 2024
- (f) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Presbyterian

Women's College of Education,
Aburi for the year 2024

- (g) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Complementary Education Agency for the year 2024
- (h) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Education, Winneba for the year 2024
- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu College of Education for the year 2024
- (j) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University for Development Studies for the year 2024

Motions

Committee Sitings

Respectfully submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Majority Leader and Chairman of the Business Committee.

The Report of the Business Committee has been duly presented and it is for comments from Members.

Yes, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi?

Mr Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Majority Leader, he has notified us that,

from the 7th July, 2025, we would have to sit on Mondays and Saturdays. Under normal circumstances, I know the House is supposed to rise *sine die* at the end of the month, but I do not know if sacrificing our Mondays and Saturdays has anything to do with our timetable.

I would be grateful if he can inform the House when the House is rising *sine die* in view of the fact that we are going to add two more sitting days out of our normal days.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, in connection with the Sittings that have been extended to Saturdays, I would like to suggest to the Leader of the House that, if possible, on Saturdays, because no time has been provided, we meet in the morning, so that we can go back to our respective constituencies and also conduct businesses over there.

Mr Speaker, the second issue has to do with the name tags on our tables. Some of them have fallen off and I think it looks untidy to enter this Chamber with some tables having name tags and some do not. So, if we have issues, let us take all of them off until we are ready to provide name tags on all the tables.

Mr Speaker, with respect, for the past two months, the 11th Floor West, rooms number 12, 14 and 16, are without air conditioners and I am told it is the same for the second Floor also. Mr Speaker, you cannot sit in your room to study or receive visitors; it is like hell. Two

months is too long a time. I will be happy if the House Committee will do something about that.

Also, regarding Papers on the console, Mr Speaker, if the ICT Department is not ready to configure their system, I will plead, in all humility, that they should provide us with the hard copies of the Papers because we need to keep some in our archives. There is no provision for archiving these Papers on the console, so the Order Paper for yesterday is no longer on the console. How do we make reference to it? They should, please, provide us with these Papers for us to have the full complement of them and keep some for reference.

Mr Speaker, on the last issue, just this week, we heard in the news that some 33 excavators developed wings and flew; they disappeared. This is a worrying signal that the 40 excavators that were seized and placed in the custody of the police, all of a sudden, became like birds and 33 of them cannot be found. This is a worrying development that we need to find answers to.

With respect to you and the Leader of the House, if we can get the Minister for the Interior here to explain to us the circumstances that led to the disappearance of these 33 excavators and their whereabouts.

Mr Speaker, thank you for your patience in indulging me.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, mine is tied to the question Hon

Anyimadu-Antwi asked on when we will rise. Mr Speaker, on the Mid-Year Budget Review, if it is actually the case that we are scheduled to adjourn *sine die* by the end of this month, the Business Statement that he has provided is up to the 12th of this month, which means we will have about two weeks, but there is no indication as to when we should expect the Mid-Year Budget Review.

Also, with regard to what Prof Nyarko concluded on, I do not know whether to say excavators getting missing or vanishing—There is the need for us to schedule the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources to brief us on the fight against *galamsey* because our water bodies are polluted, even to the extent that it is destroying our farmlands and some farm produces have been found to be not so good. I know that there is a concern on the schedule for the BoG that was raised by the Minority Chief Whip, so if we can get the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources?

The Administrator of the Minerals Development Fund is now the one leading the charge for the seizing of the excavators. I do not know whether it is the case that their Chief Executive Officers (CEOs) and administrators are now those fighting *galamsey* and, for that matter, they need a task force to arrest people. We should know who is in charge with regard to those things.

Then, Mr Speaker, there is an issue at Ghana Water Limited. About 281 staff have been dismissed. Just like how about 100 people were dismissed from BoG, about 281 staff have been dismissed

from the Ghana Water Limited. If we can get the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources, so that we would see the circumstances that led to that.

I know Mr Speaker might think that it is convenient for me to file a Question, but, sometimes, it is not everything that we ought to file Questions for. At least, if we could get a briefing on those circumstances because these are people, many of whom are family men and women, who are crying every day because their jobs have been terminated. We need to know why. It should not be a political football that we are playing, to the extent that when there is a change of Government, Ghanaian workers lose their jobs. So, if the Chairman of the Committee could find space to programme the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources.

Mr Speaker, I know he will respond by saying that the President is being responsible. Yesterday, news out there—I expected the Speaker would have briefed us under the item numbered 3 on our Order Paper that had to do with the Message from the President with regard to the outstanding four Deputy Ministers or appointments of Ministers to make it 60. They cannot say he is done. Until there is an official communication from the Speaker, left to me, nothing should be done because the Speaker is the one who will read the communication and refer it to the Committee that the First Deputy Speaker chairs. There is nothing like that, so to this House, it is still something on social media.

Lastly, Mr Speaker, I mentioned to the Majority Leader and the Chairman of the Business Committee, we heard that the President has launched the 24-Hour Economy. As important as Parliament is, we were not consulted. There was no pre-briefing for us. For the fact that it is going to cost us US\$4 billion, Members of Parliament need to understand. Why do we need to understand? We represent the people.

The 275 Members of Parliament represent the entire country, so the President cannot launch a flagship programme, 24-Hour Economy, to many sectors. I do not know how it is going to work because we are still experiencing *dumsor*. If we have *dumsor* and they cannot keep the lights on for eight hours, how does one even use electricity in the manufacturing industry to run a 24-Hour Economy?

Mr Speaker, I think at a Committee of the Whole, the coordinator or the one in charge should be able to brief us. At least, they should not ignore Parliament in this important thing, unless it is the case that it is a scam; thus, we, Members of Parliament, must not be informed. If it actually is real and the Government really wants to implement it, Parliament is an important institution and player. We cannot be asked to spend that amount of money without them coming to brief us, the representatives.

I think the Chairman of the Committee should schedule that, so that we would get to understand what exactly is contained in what the President

launched. Then with the 24-Hour Economy, is it going to be piloted? Is it that it would just go on full force? Is it the case that it would start from certain regions, such as Greater Accra, Takoradi, Kumasi, or it will be full force? We need to understand how this thing is going to work.

Mr Speaker, without saying much, these are the little things that I think the Majority Leader should respond to.

Mr Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, we would be grateful if the venerable Majority Leader would take steps to make available to this House the legal framework governing all these entrepreneurship programmes: the 24-Hour Economy, the Adwumawura Programme and all those that were approved in the Budget of this year.

Mr Speaker, the reason being that various entrepreneurship programmes have run in this country and the country has expended a lot of money on these programmes, but, oftentimes, the results are difficult to measure and scandals have broken as a result because there is no legal framework governing them.

I am inspired and guided on this path for a call to a legal framework to govern these programmes by an article which was written by the Majority Leader where, he said that, oftentimes, because of the extensive discretion which is given to the persons that run these programmes, that is why we do not see the results we are supposed to see and there are sometimes corrupt outcomes.

Mr Speaker, it is important the Majority Leader is inspired by his own article and ensure that we have a legal framework governing these programmes to limit the exercise of discretion and to avoid massive corruptions that have characterised such programmes.

12.57 p.m.

Mr Speaker, very respectfully, if the Majority Leader can assist us, given that we have oversight responsibility over the public purse, I believe that the legal framework would enable us exercise proper oversight over these programmes.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Dr Mahama?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Mr Speaker, just following from what my respected Colleague, the MP for Manhyia South, — mindful of the fact that the Electoral Commission (EC) has issued a statement to the effect that some election is going to be conducted. I am mindful of the independence of the EC and the need for their work, but the EC is accountable to the good people of Ghana. If the respected Leader of the House will be minded, and it so pleases, the EC should be invited to justify to the good people of Ghana why a rerun of 19 polling stations has to be conducted in a constituency in Ghana.

Mr Speaker, I am saying this mindful of the fact that that Constituency has

been without representation for almost seven months. And it is also important that they have representation, but the conduct is going to determine the stability or otherwise of the country. Parliament should be concerned about the decision. So, I am just asking the Leader of the House to invite the Electoral Commission to give us the basis in line with Article 23 and 296 of the Constitution, the discretion that the EC has to come up with this particular directive. I think Parliament has to be informed accordingly for us to also be informed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me join hands with Colleagues who earlier raised a matter concerning the sudden vanishing of excavators. Thirty-three out of 40 excavators, I think, is a matter that is of public interest and importance. I must commend the Leader for the achievement where now proceedings and Committee meetings will be carried live. I think it has been a vision of past Leaders to get this thing crystallised and under his watch, the two Leadership have put their heads together and it is commendable. However, I think the ultimate should be concerns about the engagements of the Ghanaian public by this House. The Public Affairs Department should step up its engagements with the Ghanaian people. That is an aspect I find important and quite as a missing link.

The Leader spoke of the possibility of we sitting on Saturday and Monday. Generally, I am not sure Members are opposed, but there are fundamental considerations and the Chief Whip, whom I am not sure is paying attention to me, has to do these things; the in-House considerations for the Saturday and Monday sitting. Chief Whip, we are in your hands. Let us make sure these concerns are sorted.

Mr Speaker, I think about two weeks ago, the Business Committee had resolved following a suggestion from Members who had lamented on how referrals are getting dusty and not being dealt with. And one of the strategies was to ensure that these referrals are repeated in subsequent Businesses of the House when they are presented. So, we mentioned specific referrals and the Committee Leadership, for example, Finance Committee. They released the outstanding Businesses that have been referred to them and not being dealt with. I think the Hon Leader acceded to that call; we practised it the last time and I realised this draft is conspicuously missing. I think we should revisit that and that will put some pressure on the Committee Leaders to make sure these works are being dispensed with.

Mr Speaker, last week, I related to the 2.4 per cent increment by the Public Utility Regulatory Commission (PURC) in terms of electricity utility. And I had also made the point that the tariffs, Leader — I have also made the point that the variables are taking a nosedive; exchange rates, inflation, weighted average cost of gas and international

market and all that. And the Leader has said that. I was opting for the PURC's Executive Secretary. The Leader has said that it should rather be the Minister for Energy and Green Transition. So there was an agreement; there was a prior agreement that this should be done. It finds no expression in this Business of the House. Thankfully, we do not have any briefing captured by the draft report so far, so there is space. So let us make room for the Minister for Energy and Green Transition to be here on PURC's 2.45 per cent electricity tariff.

Let me conclude on the *galamsey*. Mr Speaker, it is heart-wrenching that farm products harvested in the areas or parts of Eastern Region, Anyinam and its environs — I see my respected MP is here. It is reported that mercury is found in some of these farm products. It may be true or not. It has been widely reported. Now, the *galamseyers* are now heading to the main road; the Accra-Kumasi road is under threat. Turbidity levels of our water bodies are getting out of hand. We cannot be silent as the people's representatives. The Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Armah-Kofi Buah, who has refused and backed by the Executive, refused to bring the mining lease agreement — Anytime I raise it, Majority Leader says he is in agreement with me. It is one thing being in agreement and it is another thing raising the matter and convincing Cabinet to ensure that this agreement is brought to this House.

Why would the Executive take us for granted? Up till now, it has been more than a month. Goldfields and Damang

are mining. It has been three months and the people's representatives have still not seen these agreements. Coupled with the fact that water bodies are being destroyed; farmlands are being destroyed with the intended effect of food security. We cannot keep quiet. Mr Armah-Kofi Buah should find his way here. Next week, he should be the next Minister on the bill. Apart from the Minister for Energy and Green Transition, the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources should be here. Unless, of course, they are telling us that now they are not interested in the *galamsey* fight, then the people of this country will know. Majority Leader, — I saw him writing notes. I hope my suggestion finds convenience with him and he has included this. These matters are important.

I would conclude on flooding. Mr Speaker, the rains have won and the signs are clear. So, what is the work of the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources? What is NADMO also doing? Let us not wait to hear reports of places in Accra being flooded, lives being lost before we hurriedly run to brief the House.

Let us make hay while the sun shines. Mr Speaker, in summary, these are my observations. And I hope the Leader will take it in good stride and respond positively to it.

I thank you, Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any other observation? Hon Minority Leader,

if you have observations, let us take all on board.

1.07 p.m.

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, thank you. I have a couple of issues that I would put across for the Leader of Government Business to take up and I believe that these are national issues that will help the governance of our country.

Mr Speaker, issue number one which has already been raised by our colleague Dr Kabiru of the Walewale constituency. Yesterday, we woke up to a surprise announcement by the Electoral Commission (EC). The Electoral Commission announced to the nation that there is going to be some elections on the 11th July and today they have put out some polling stations that according to them are the polling stations that the elections will take place. I want to tell the Electoral Commission that they are dealing with issues of their own integrity. Because when the Mandamus order was granted by the court and they were in the process of finalising the coalition and there were disturbances, they themselves issued a public statement and addressed the press telling the people of Ghana that indeed they have only three polling stations left to finalise the coalition process to enable them to declare.

Mr Speaker, not long after that, they themselves wrote to the Ghana Police Service requesting for police protection. A Member of this House filed an Urgent Question—Which question compelled the EC to come here? A lot of supplementary questions were asked.

The Deputy Chair, Dr Bosman, sitting in for his boss, told us that all they need is security to enable them finish the three polling stations. I ask a question. What has changed? Mr Speaker, we should be careful as a democracy and how we are managing this democracy.

Mr Speaker, today we have a Member in this Chamber from Dome Kwabenya, because when it was left with some few polling stations, EC relied on tally cards. “Ad3n, Mike Oquaye Jnr, *ony3 nipa, ony3 Ghana ni?*” to wit “Is Mike Oquaye Jnr not a human being or a Ghanaian?” Mike Oquaye Jnr protested, but he did not protest with violence. He did not carry his constituents to the EC coalition centre. He expressed his disagreement in a civil way.

Today, we have our Colleague, Akurugu with us because EC used tally cards to complete the coalition process and when it is clear that the EC was on course to complete this process, we are being told today that there is going to be rerun of some constituencies. It is unfair; it is unjust. Is it the case, and I do not want to believe that that is the case, that the recent public comment by some senior politicians is what is compelling EC perhaps to secure their job? They want to succumb to the whims and caprices of certain extremists or certain hardliners. It is not fair. Maybe today it is helping some other people, tomorrow, it may be their turn.

Mr Speaker, with all of this said, I would humbly plead with my Colleagues opposite me to programme the EC. We just received Prime Minister Modi

talking about our strides in democracy. Let us not wish them away. In the sub-region, many countries wish they were Ghana. They are not Ghana because they took their institutions for granted and today, they are paying dearly for it. Let us not say to ourselves, had I known. EC must come here and brief us why, in spite of their being unequivocal, they have now changed course. We must not allow this. So, Mr Speaker, I expect that on issue one, next week, the EC will be programmed to come and brief the House. We see some people are with all smiles. They are not questioning the 19 because it suits them. We see them, smiles all over, broad smiles on their faces.

Mr Speaker, issue two, my respected Colleague, Mr Annoh-Dompreh and Alhaji Habib, MP for Tolon, have raised this matter and I proceed to raise it again at the risk of being repetitive. The Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC) and the Government, within six months, have increased electricity tariffs by 16.45 per cent, almost 17 per cent. In Akufo-Addo's eight years, we did not see an increase in electricity tariffs at that level. Rather, the Akufo-Addo's government that was criticised by the National Democratic Congress (NDC) reduced electricity tariffs. Mr Speaker, today, within six months, they started with 14 per cent and they have added 2.45 per cent. Why?

The Minister for Energy and Green Transition should come to this House and share with us the reform they are undertaking instead of burdening Ghanaians with tax. Why increase by

almost 17 per cent, when at the same time you claim you are introducing 24-hour economy with electricity tariffs as part of the incentives? Mr Speaker, this government must know that it made promises, was it a promise that they were going to increase electricity tariffs? Almost 17 per cent in six months. This is unacceptable. So, Mr Speaker, I do not want the Majority Leader to wish this away. This is not the normal politics. The Minister for Energy and Green Transition should come to this House and tell us—In fact, the Minority caucus has come out with a policy document on this matter and will share it with the public. Government has no such justification to increase electricity tariffs 14 per cent and 2.4 per cent just within six months. It is not acceptable.

Mr Speaker, they launched their so-called 24-hour economy yesterday without due regard to Parliament and Alhaji Habib Iddrisu emphasised that. But I will give some details. Now, they say that the 24-hour economy policy will require 4 billion. Meanwhile, they have only a paltry sum of 300 to 400 million in public funding by way of commitment and you say the rest is on a private sector investment promises. This is very vague. You go on a campaign platform to create the impression that they have something of value. Then they come with a vague promise that the rest is private sector. Meanwhile, there are no incentives for the private sector. Since they came into office, they should share with us a single incentive they have introduced for the private sector. Even the One District, One Factory (1D1F) policy, they have

cancelled it. Then they say the rest of it is coming from the private sector.

I want to ask the government and I want the Leader of Government Business to take this on board. The heavy dependence on the PPPs and the SPVs without clarity on structure, risk sharing or funding sources makes this vague. So, they should come again.

Two, non-alignment with Ghana's debt sustainability plan under IMF programme still makes this policy vague.

No medium-term fiscal framework or concrete revenue mobilisation strategy to support this programme makes it vague.

1.17 p.m

This policy is vague. There is no medium-term fiscal framework or concrete revenue mobilisation strategy to support this programme. This makes it vague. The risk of unbalanced sheet liability that could burden taxpayers also makes this vague.

Mr Speaker, we in the Minority see this as a mere Public Relations (PR) tool to distract from real-time economic hardship and win public goodwill. Because they have just increased tariffs. They even introduced a levy which the people call the *Dumsor* Levy, the energy recovery or whatever sustainability levy they introduced. The *Dumsor* Levy, which is going to take GHC4.50p per gallon of petrol that Ghanaians buy. And we had a Majority Leader supporting it by saying, and I quote him: “only one

litre”. That was the Majority Leader. Is one litre only?

Mr Speaker, this Government should not take their people for granted. We need the Minister for Finance to come here and brief us with proper information on this matter because the President told us during the Message on the State of the Nation that the Minister for Finance will brief us on this matter. So, we expect him to come.

Mr Speaker, on the *galamsey* fight, the Trade Union Congress (TUC), Organised Labour, was bold on May Day to express its displeasure and its disgust on what is happening. In fact, according to the TUC, the situation has even worsened. Today, we know what is happening there. Can the former Deputy Leader of this House, who is now the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, come and really brief this House on what he is doing to stop this *galamsey*? It was a major campaign tool, that the Akufo-Addo Government could not do much and that the National Democratic Congress (NDC) Government would introduce a state of emergency on this matter. Where is the state of emergency? What are we hearing?

Mr Speaker, with the water bodies that are being destroyed, Ghana Water Limited can no longer guarantee us potable water. Is the Government saying that it is not aware of this? We need the Minister here. He should not be comfortable in his Ministry. We are tired of the talks. We want action, and I will

plead with my Colleague, Leader of Government Business, to programme him to come and brief us on the Ministerial policy on this matter.

Mr Speaker, my last but not least point is this matter of mass dismissals. Yes, we have heard about Bank of Ghana retreating and re-engaging the workers. But, Mr Speaker, a lot were sacked at the Ghana Water Limited. People were long employed before December 2024. Ghana Maritime Authority, Ghana Revenue Authority—Ghana Education Service (GES) employed a lot of teachers who are still in the rural areas teaching, yet they have not been regularised. Mr Speaker, at Bulk Oil Storage and Transportation Company Limited (BOST), some security personnel who were employed have all been dismissed just last week.

Mr Speaker, this is not good for the image of our country. Who knows what will happen in 2028? So, some Ghanaians are considered as not being part of the Government because they are not party people; they are sacked. Then, another government comes and another group also goes to sit at home.

Mr Speaker, we are not nurturing talent. The various sector heads should take this seriously. We cannot continue to allow this to happen to our country. Enough of this.

Mr Speaker, I will plead with the Leader of Government Business to programme the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment to give us an update. The last time he said there were some

investigations going on. I will plead with him. Can we imagine what will happen to Parliament if the over 150 people who were employed by Parliament after the election are sent home? If Mr Speaker had implemented the letter from the Chief of Staff, what would happen to Parliament?

I will repeat one more time, our Friend Mr Okudzeto Ablakwa is on record to have said that although he saw the letter, he felt that this thing will not help the country. I commend Mr Ablakwa, the Minister for Foreign Affairs, for saying that having perused the records, the people were interviewed long before the elections. If Mr Ablakwa can take this step, why are the other institutional heads even going back to 2017? At Ghana Maritime Authority, people with their contract of employment from 2017—At Ghana Export-Import Bank (Ghana EXIMBank), they sacked people whose employment dated back to 2018.

Mr Speaker, we have to be careful of how we are polarising our country. I pray that the Hon Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment will come here.

Mr Speaker, I had said earlier that last but not least, but forgive me, there is one more point I skipped. Mr Speaker, my Colleagues and I in the Minority Caucus are not against accountability. When people get into public offices, they should reasonably expect that someday they would have to account for their stewardship. But what is happening in this country today will not help the course of democracy.

Mr Speaker, Mr Abdul Hanan Wahab, former Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of National Food Buffer Stock Company, and his wife, were arrested by Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO) on 25th June, 2025, for some alleged offences. Mr Speaker, can you imagine that EOCO has now introduced a certain bail condition? For the mere fact that it is investigating, it tells the person to go and bring titled property or bring GH¢50 million. If the person does not have that property worth that amount, that person will stay in their cells. They did it to Chairman Wontumi. They have done it to Mr Kwabena Adu-Boahene, someone who has served as a security chief for over 20 years. And now, it is Mr Hanan Wahab and his wife. This man they are investigating was a former New Patriotic Party (NPP) candidate for Pusiga. Can they not grant the person bail, especially when the person is in Ghana?

Mr Speaker, if this precedence is allowed—Let us be careful.

When Former President Kufuor came in 2000, the NPP thought that it would be in power for a long time. By 2008, NPP lost and NDC came again. In 2016, the NDC thought it would win, then NPP came. Can we not as a political class, for once, sit down and stop this?

Mr Speaker, I will conclude by encouraging the Majority Leader to programme the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. He supervises EOCO. Maybe some Hon Members may not be happy with me, but tomorrow — some of them are serving as Ministers or

serving as Board Chairs — they may rely on this for their comfort. Can you imagine they come for you and your wife; in 2029, if power changes and demand—the Hon Member can shake his hands, do not worry. We do not control destiny. But just imagine it, that they come and tell us that we should go and produce property worth GH¢50 million when it is only an investigation. At least, if EOCO is minded, it should go to court. If EOCO believes strongly in its case, that it has uncovered some rot, they should go to court and apply for a bench bail or, they should say that the court should grant bail on these conditions for the court to determine. That one, they will be pursuing justice and would be acting in the interest of our fellow Ghanaians. But with what they are doing, they will be in their office and talking about administrative discretion, that somebody should bring property. And this man has been in their custody for weeks. If one goes there, they would say they have granted bail, but the person has not met the condition. If they make the bail condition onerous—I will plead with my respected friend, Mr Raymond Archer, the Executive Director of EOCO, and his team to look at this again. It is not helping our country. Ghana has moved past this. People are suffering.

1.27 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I rest my case and pray that the Leader of the House will look at the issues raised and address them for us.

I thank you.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let me thank Hon Members for the issues raised regarding the Report of the Business

Committee. I have said several times that we turn the Business Committee Report discussions into press conferences. This is not the best practice, but we persist in that. So, let me respond as copiously as the issues were raised.

First, the Electoral Commission—I have a press release by the Electoral Commission dated 2nd July, 2025 and it reads:

“ELECTIONS IN SELECTED
POLLING STATIONS IN ABLEKUMA
NORTH CONSTITUENCY

As part of its commitment to resolve the impasse regarding the Ablekuma North Constituency Parliamentary elections, the Electoral Commission, yesterday, Tuesday, 1st July, 2025, met with the representatives of the National Democratic Congress (NDC) and New Patriotic Party (NPP).

The meeting, which was a follow-up to an earlier meeting held on Thursday, 12th June, 2025, provided both Parties the opportunity to brief the Commission on any new developments regarding the said Constituency. The Parties informed the Commission that their positions put forward at the last meeting remained unchanged.

- The NDC held the view that the elections should be rerun in thirty-seven (37) Polling Stations because scanned Pink Sheets from 37 polling stations which were used to collate the results were provided by the NPP.

- The NPP was of the view that the results from three (3) outstanding Polling Stations be collated and a winner declared, since the NDC Agents had verified and confirmed the scanned Polling Station results they presented.

It is important for the public to understand that the issue in contention has to do with the fact that 37 pink sheets provided by the NPP and used to collate the results were scanned copies”.

So, the Electoral Commission is saying that the issue in contention is that 37 pink sheets provided by the NPP are scanned copies, not original.

“The public may recall that political party supporters besieged our Collation Centre and destroyed a number of the Pink Sheets for the Ablekuma North Parliamentary Elections during the collation of results following the December 7th General Elections.

After extensive deliberations, the Commission informed the Political Parties that it will proceed to rerun the election in 19 out of the 37 Polling Stations. The Commission arrived at the decision to rerun the election in the underlisted Polling Stations because, the 19 scanned Polling Station results used for the collation, though approved by Agents of both Political Parties, were not verified by the Presiding Officers responsible for those Polling Stations”.

This is the reason. The Electoral Commission is saying that their own presiding officers did not verify the 19 polling stations so they do not think that

those polling station results should be used and that is why they are deciding to rerun those 19 polling stations.

The Hon Member made reference to the presentations made by the EC in this House. If he recalls, after the presentation by the EC, I drew their attention to the fact that the matter in contention was the issue of verification of the scanned pink sheets and that their own presiding officers did not verify the pink sheets and that day he was called on this House to help them to have security to collate the results.

And I said that for this House to help the Commission, this House has to verify that what the Commissioners told us is true and I know because everything happened on television and the presiding officers did not verify those pink sheets. So, if the Commission want us to help you, we will conduct an enquiry in this House and if we establish that own presiding officers of the Commission verified those pink sheets, then we will direct the police to come and provide you with the protection the Commission needs to collate the results.

This is what has made them to go back, think over it, and now decide that they have to come clean on the fact that their own presiding officers did not verify the scanned pink sheets. If the scanned pink sheets were not verified by their own presiding officers, on what basis should that be used? That is why they are calling for a rerun of those 19 polling stations.

I do not know why the Minority is afraid. So, please, let us not try to politicise this and say that because, recently, the national chairman of one political party made a statement, the EC is intimidated. No, it is just fair and reasonable that if their own officers did not verify those pink sheets, they rerun those polling stations.

Mr Speaker, on *galamsey* activities, indeed, it is our promise that we will deal firmly and ruthlessly with *galamsey*. We have embarked on a relentless war to end *galamsey*. We have confiscated a lot of excavators. Indeed, if you go around the country and you go to *galamsey* sites, you will not see excavators engaged in *galamsey* operations. That I can assure you.

We still have some of our own citizens engaged in the artisanal mining activities. Indeed, long before *galamsey* became a major issue, artisanal small-scale mining activities were ongoing in our various communities. What made it a major environmental problem is when sponsors introduced the use of huge earth-moving equipment, that is excavators, dozers, tipper tractors, tracks, *et cetera*, that increased astronomically the level of devastation of our environment.

If we are able to stop the excavators and earth-moving equipment from being used and even just confine it to the artisanal activities of people just using pickaxes, *et cetera*, we would have considerably narrowed down the extent of damage caused by *galamsey*. So, I am happy and I can report with all

confidence that the level of devastation that we saw a year ago is no longer happening at the *galamsey* sites—[Hear! Hear!]

We are not saying that we have totally wiped out *galamsey*, but we have dealt a deadly blow at *galamsey*. We have recovered the forest. Those who are involved and those who have taken over our forest, we have recovered the forest and the Minister was here and he reported on all these things. So, please, do not present a picture out there as if nothing has been done about *galamsey*.

Mr Speaker, the legal framework for policies being raised earlier and in particular the issue of the 24-Hour Economy that was launched yesterday, one must understand 24-Hour Economy and it was presented to this House by the head of the Secretariat. He came here during a Committee of the Whole Meeting and he did a presentation to us and it was launched yesterday.

1.37 p.m.

All Ghanaians were invited to the launch and as Members of Parliament, even when we are not invited to an event, we monitor the events on the radio. Many of the issues that Members have raised here, they heard them on the radio. They read them on social media and on various platforms. They were not there. Were they there when the 16 excavators got missing? How did they get to know? They heard that one, but they did not hear about the launching of the 24-Hour Economy. Selective hearing.

So, for the 24-Hour Economy, the US\$4 billion that is being discussed is not the money of Government. The US\$4 billion is going to be private sector money, with small Government support, to catalyse those ones. Those matters were mentioned in the Budget.

The President informed Parliament during the Message on the State of the Nation. The Minister for Finance mentioned it here in Parliament during the reading of the Budget Statement; and when he comes for the reading of the Mid-Year Budget Review, he will repeat it. Every single policy, when it requires legislative approval, rest assured, I sit in Cabinet, it will come to this Parliament for approval. It is not going to be a policy or a programme that will not be monitored.

And the Member asked a question on incentives. That no incentive had been introduced by this Government since assuming office; that is palpably untrue. Mr Speaker, since this Government took over, we have introduced policies that have led to the strengthening of the Ghana cedi. That is the major hindrance to the private sector.

When we had an unstable currency that was ballooning and one could not predict, project and plan their businesses, negotiate with their suppliers, determine prices because the dollar was changing every day, and they had difficulties managing their businesses, some actually closed their shops and moved to our neighbouring countries.

There can be no incentive better than bringing the dollar down and stabilising it. That is the greatest incentive to the business community. [*Hear! Hear!*] There is no better incentive than managing inflation properly and we have managed inflation properly. There is no business incentive better than keeping the moneys in the banks, so that when businesses need money and they go to the banks, they have money to borrow.

When Government goes there and uses Treasury Bills and takes all the moneys from the banks and businesses cannot go to the banks and borrow, no matter what tax exemptions we give them under the One District One Factory (1D1F) Initiative, they will collapse. They will fail, run and leave this country.

But today, the Government is not borrowing from the banks. There is so much money in the banks. Some businessmen have told me that banks are chasing them with money and they do not need the money. That is the best incentive that we can have for the private sector. We are fighting corruption ruthlessly and that is what the business community needs. That we would fight corruption and deal with red tapes, so that business can move smoothly unhindered.

Lastly, as we do this, the international rating agencies are rating us better. Those are the real incentives that our private sector need. Again, they need stable and reliable electricity. That is why we are taking steps to make sure that they have reliable energy. To deal with the reliable energy, we must deal with the debt.

Yesterday, the Minister for Energy and Green Transition was in this House and he communicated that we have a debt of over GHC64 billion in the energy sector. This debt must be paid and who has to pay it? It still has to be the same taxpayer, the same consumer — [*Interruption*]— No, he asked the questions; I will give him the answers. Why does he want me to conclude?

That is why a 14 or 16 per cent increase is fair because a debt of GHC64 billion owed by the energy sector has to be paid. It has to be paid by consumers, taxpayers and managed by the Government. The Minister was at pains yesterday to explain the extent to which he is ensuring that the debt is reduced through efficiency in the management of the sector and in procurement.

I know of agencies that — Since the NDC took over, we have discovered that some agencies have procured goods and services that will only be used or can only be consumed for five years. Why? Why would one procure goods and services that can only be consumed in five years? Why do we burden an agency to that extent? That is why we are compelled to introduce increments in tariffs to address those issues.

Let us get to employment and the so-called complaints of dismissal. Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs is a different ballgame. There are state-owned companies and corporations that will never make profits because we have saddled them with huge labour expenditure. We have employed and

recruited far beyond the numbers they need to be able to perform properly and profitably. So, some of them are compelled to lay off some of the workers; otherwise, they can never be profitable.

The Committee on Energy had a retreat with the energy sector agencies. Ghana Gas Company reported to the Committee on Energy that when the Ghana Gas facilities were established, they had 120 workers managing the facilities. The facilities are still the same; they have not increased in space. Today, they have 1,200 workers.

A facility that can be managed by 120 workers and we go and burden that facility with 1,200 workers; yet, they have not added additional facilities. The same plant, no change and they want the management to continue to make profits with that level of burden. That is why, in some cases, when they have an opportunity, they will have to make sure that they cancel the employments, so that they can have some room to manage and try to be profitable. So, please, let us clean the mess. This country has to be reset.

Some of us have to pay a price, so that this country can be reset. I plead with us to not over-politicise every single decision that has been taken. This is because if we are to really go on that route, everything that the Minority did, we will expose them.

Mr Speaker, the issue about the four Deputy Ministers, I am sure that when the appointment is done, the communication will be to your very good self and you will announce it. I have

already touched on the excavators. We will check with the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources if, indeed, any excavator got missing and where it went missing. He will come and explain to this House.

As regards Sitting times, yes, if we are to sit on Mondays and Saturdays, I think, ideally, if we sat early in the mornings during Mondays and Saturdays, we can close early and attend our funerals and other programmes. The date for the Mid-Year Budget Review will be communicated to us very soon by the Minister for Finance. I am sure we can communicate the date on a Saturday; do not worry about that.

Also, on the condition of the air conditioners, I am sure they are being worked on by the relevant officers. Yes, we agree that all outstanding referrals should be listed, so that we can put pressure on the various Chairpersons of Committees to enable them to deliver on their promise to this House.

Mr Speaker, I am grateful for the opportunity and I urge Members to adopt the Report of the Business Committee.

Mr Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader started by saying that people have turned the Business of the House into a press conference.

1.47 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader started by saying that people have turned the Business Statement into a press conference. So, I was expecting him to answer the questions that he needed to answer and ignore the press conference aspect but instead, in the dispatch box, he

joined the people doing the press conference, and this is not fair. This should not be encouraged. In so doing, he forgot the answer that I required. My question was that, since we are going to Sit on Mondays and Saturdays, does it affect our timetable? Because of his press conference, he forgot.

Mr Speaker has not called him yet.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think because we want to Sit for a certain number of days in order to be able to have our Legislative Instrument (L.I.) mature, the proposal was whether we should extend when we will go on recess or utilise Mondays and Saturdays so that we do not have to extend when we go on recess.

Mr Speaker opted to allow us to Sit on Mondays. I think the planned recess was supposed to be around the 25th or 26th July. So, we are hoping to keep within that timeframe.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Leader and Mr Anyimadu-Antwi raised a very important issue and as a House, we need to give it a thorough deliberation. Hon Members, the Rules governing the Business Statement are very clear. Order 69 and 71 are very clear. Order 216, which indicates what the Business Committee is supposed to do, is also very clear. But during the time of the presentation of the Business Statement, we make comments that are not supposed to be integrated into the Business Statement or that will not necessarily call for a supplementary Business Statement. The picture is not looking good. Whether or not a President will do appointments, is this a matter to

be programmed for this House? Is the bail condition by Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO) a matter to be programmed by this House? So why are we doing this to ourselves? Everyday, at the presentation of the Business Statement, it is as if we are doing a press conference. The comment is supposed to be on the Business Statement as presented. And we continue to inflict this injury to ourselves? Well, I indicated that I owe fidelity to the Rules, and let me indicate that going forward, we need to operate within the rules.

Hon Members, the Business Statement as presented is hereby adopted by the House.

Majority Leader, any indication?

Before then, let me acknowledge the presence of students visiting us. We have students from the Air Force Station Basic School, led by Captain George Amofo, an Administrative Officer, and they are coming all the way from Takoradi. They are 179 in number.

[Students from Air Force Station Basic School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then we have St Joseph R/C Junior High School, led by Frank Akwasi, a teacher, and they are from Obuasi East. They are 83 in number.

[Students from St Joseph R/C Junior High School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have Teshie Lekma “1” Junior High School, led by Anita Brafoa Adu, a teacher, and

they are from the Ledzokuku, Constituency. They 73 in number.

[Students from Teshie Lekma “1” Junior High School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: On behalf of the House, I welcome you to Parliament of Ghana, and may you have a fruitful visit. Thank you for coming.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we are in your hands. I think that we want to be able to adjourn early today. So, can we take adjournment to Monday at 10:00 a.m.? Mr Speaker, we started at 9:00 a.m. It is past five hours. So, we are in your hands.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, it is few minutes to 2:00 p.m. So, may you move a Motion for adjournment.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I move that this House be adjourned to Monday at 10: 00 a.m. in the forenoon.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, having the Majority Leader indicate that he has no further Business, I will second the Motion. This is an indication that the 24-Hour Economy is *yaa mutu*. It is just 2 p.m. and he said we should close.

So, Mr Speaker, I second the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Minority Whip, I understand some early adjournments are at the instance of Members. Tomorrow being a

holiday, they will be travelling to their constituencies. That necessitated the early adjournment. So, I am inclined to ask the Majority Leader to withdraw the Motion, so that we go back to do Business.

Yes, Mr Anyimadu-Antwi?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, before we adjourn the House, I want to find out from the Majority Leader— Sometimes we Sit at 2.00 p.m. and sometimes we Sit at 10.00 a.m. I would have thought that Monday being the first day of the week — *[Interruption]* But if we are Sitting at 2.00 p.m., let us know so that everybody would plan. Saturdays are an exception. If we are coming in the morning, then that would be allowed. So, Majority Leader, I would suggest that on Mondays, Sitting should be at 2.00 p.m. as we Sit on the other days, and then on Saturdays, we can come early, so that we can travel.

Please, the Majority Leader said that we should Sit at 10.00 a.m. on next week Monday and that is what I am saying that we should continue with the normal

2.00p.m.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 1:58 p.m. till Monday, 7th July, 2025 at 2.00 in the afternoon.

